

Hitler & The Nazi Party



By:Gavi,Susi
per:5



Hitler's Core Beliefs

- **Anti-Semitism**- Hatred and prejudice against Jewish people
- **Extreme Nationalism**-Belief that Germany should be stronger and more important than all other countries.
- **Social Darwinism**-The false idea that “strong races” should dominate and “weak races” should disappear.
- **Aryan Superiority**-Belief that Germans with blond hair and blue eyes were the “master race.”
- **Lebensraum**- Idea that Germany needed to conquer more land for its people.

After World War I, many Germans were poor, angry, and humiliated.

Hitler promised pride, jobs, and strength.



Germany's Crisis

- Treaty of Versailles-Peace treaty that forced Germany to accept blame for WWI and pay huge penalties.
- Economic Depression-Worldwide economic collapse that hit Germany very hard.
- Unemployment numbers-Up to 6 million Germans had no jobs.
- Political instability-The democratic government could not solve the crisis.

Why people listened to Hitler: People were desperate and wanted a strong leader with quick solutions.



Gaining Power Legally

- Beer Hall Putsch-Hitler's failed attempt to take power by force.
- Mein Kampf-Book Hitler wrote in prison explaining his ideas and plans.
- Growth of the Nazi Party-They gained support using propaganda and promises.
- Chancellor in 1933 -Hitler was legally appointed head of government.
- Enabling Act- Law that allowed Hitler to make laws without parliament.

Why it was a turning point:

It legally turned a democracy into a dictatorship



Eliminating Opposition

- Abolishing other political parties-All parties except the Nazi Party were banned, making Germany a one-party state
- Control of Reichstag-The Nazi government controlled Germany's parliament, passing laws without real opposition
- Role of SS-The SS acted as Hitler's loyal force, using fear, surveillance, and violence to silence enemies
- Concentration camps - Early camps imprisoned communists, socialists, and other opponents

Why is this considered a “legal dictatorship”?

It is considered a “legal dictatorship” because Hitler used laws and government authority to eliminate opposition and gain total power while maintaining the appearance of legality.



Controlling the People

- Propaganda (Goebbels)- Joseph Goebbels controlled newspapers, books, art, and education to spread Nazi ideas and antisemitism
- Radio & film-Cheap radios and movies spread Hitler's speeches and messages to millions of Germans
- Nuremberg rallies- Huge mass gatherings created excitement, unity, and loyalty to Hitler
- 1936 Olympics-The Berlin Games were used to show Germany as strong, modern, and peaceful
- Youth indoctrination- Children were trained in Nazi beliefs through groups like the Hitler Youth

Why was propaganda essential to maintaining power?

Propaganda was essential because the Nazis needed people not only to obey but to believe in the regime. By controlling media, education, and public events, the government shaped how Germans thought, limited criticism, and built strong loyalty to Hitler, making resistance less likely.



The Nuremberg Laws (1935)

- Jews were defined by ancestry, not religion, meaning even converts were classified as Jewish
- Jews lost German citizenship and basic political rights
- Marriage and relationships between Jews and non-Jewish Germans were banned
- Jews were forced to carry identification and were excluded from many public places

Why were laws an important step before violence?

Laws made discrimination official and normalized prejudice, making it easier for the government and society to later accept violence against Jews.



Kristallnacht (1938)

- Nazi mobs attacked Jewish homes, businesses, and synagogues across Germany and Austria on November 9–10, 1938
- Thousands of buildings were destroyed, windows were smashed, and synagogues were burned
- About 30,000 Jewish men were arrested and sent to concentration camps
- Jews were forced to pay for the damage and faced new restrictions on businesses, schools, and public life.

How did this event mark an escalation?

It marked an escalation because persecution shifted from discriminatory laws to large-scale, open violence supported by the Nazi government.



The Systematic Pattern

Timeline (1919–1939)

1919–1923: Nazi ideology emerges; street violence; small party

1924–1932: Propaganda and electoral growth; support rises during crisis

1933: Enabling Act → total government control; opponents arrested

1935: Nuremberg Laws → Jews lose citizenship and rights

1938–1939: Full exclusion, property confiscation, open violence, mass arrests

Persecution was gradual because the Nazi regime moved step by step from propaganda to discriminatory laws, loss of rights, and finally open violence between 1919 and 1939.

Reflection

1. Why did many ordinary Germans support or accept these changes?

Many Germans wanted jobs, stability, and national pride. Some believed Nazi promises, and others were too afraid to resist.

2. What warning signs of authoritarianism can you identify?

Loss of rights, control of the media, banning opposition parties, and blaming minority groups.

3. Why is it important to understand how systematic this process was?

Because it shows that a dictatorship can grow slowly, step by step, and people may not notice until it is too late.

